

To Prospective Members

Last update: March, 2026

If you are looking for a position in our lab, please read the following instructions carefully.

Position Types / Openings

- **PhD** - PhD student (no positions anymore for 2025 fall)
- **Visiting** - visiting student (if you are currently a student in a university and want to visit our lab temporarily, like 3 - 6 months, this is probably what you want)
- **RA** - research assistant (this is a full-time job for at least 1 year)
- **Postdoc** - (this is also a full-time job for at least 2 years)

In general, the bar for prospective PhD students > RA/Postdoc > visiting.

What kind of students are we looking for? The lab mission, as detailed in a set of internal slides (ELG), is as follows.

Our Mission & Core Values



- **Mission.** The mission of the lab is to cultivate scientific research talents with integrity, independence, and international competitiveness (“正直、独立、具有国际竞争力的科研力量”).

Ph.D. students are expected to demonstrate this kind of research talent; in particular, we value independence and responsibility. Because of this, we have a rule for prospective Ph.D. students: **it is a must to have on-site collaboration with us if you apply for the Ph.D. position in our lab**. If you are looking for a Ph.D. student position for *Year N, Fall*, we suggest you contact us before the start of Year N-1 Summer (typically around the NeurIPS deadline, i.e., May of Year N-1), so that we can arrange a summer internship for you. The internship is paper-oriented (typically targeting ICLR or CVPR). We shall provide compensation for your on-site work.

Self-Introduction

My name is **Huan Wang** (王欢, he/him/his). I am a **Tenure-Track Assistant Professor** at [Westlake University](#) (Hangzhou, China), **principal investigator (PI) of ENCODE Lab** (Efficient Neural Computing and Design Lab, “高效智能计算实验室” in Chinese). I earned my Ph.D. (2024) at Northeastern University (Boston, USA). Before that, I spent seven wonderful years at Zhejiang University (Hangzhou, China) earning my bachelor's and master's degrees in the College of ISEE (浙大信电学院). I mainly work on problems in AI (Efficient AI) and computing, with a focus on multimodal and generative AI now. Please visit my [webpage](#) for more information.

Lab Introduction

- **General background.** Westlake now has four schools. I am in the [School of Engineering](#), which has six programs. I am with the [Artificial Intelligence and Data Science \(AI\) program](#). We are dedicated to advancing influential innovations in the theories and

applications of various AI subfields, aiming to cultivate the next generation of global leaders through inspiring research projects that motivate their professional development.

- **Research directions of the lab.** I am interested in a variety of topics in CV & ML, but at this point, the lab is most focused on **Efficient AI in various tasks (e.g., multimodal AI, GenAI)**, specifically,
 - “hot topics”:
 - LLM/MLLM, generative modelling;
 - token compression for video LLMs;
 - agents / agentic learning, reasoning.
 - (mainly focus on inference, not training)
 - classical model compression and acceleration algorithms:
 - quantization, network pruning, distillation, low-rank decomposition, efficient architecture design, or search;
 - speculative decoding.
 - MLSys, AI4Sys and Sys4AI:
 - LLM serving;
 - code generation and kernel generation.
 - (Please refer to [my webpage](#) for more details of my past research directions.)
- **Advising style and lab culture.**
 - I am pretty **hands-on**. I'll regularly meet with students, discuss, help write the paper, code (if needed), etc., especially for junior students.
 - Meanwhile, you will have **sufficient freedom** to develop your ideas and capabilities.
 - We value an **equal, chill, and creative** working environment. Essentially, we are colleagues at Westlake, working together to solve challenging problems.
- **What we can provide.**
 - **Research-oriented projects** with competitive compensation and a comfortable working environment.
 - We encourage students to do research-oriented **internships**. We will do our best to help find opportunities.
 - We encourage students to **attend academic conferences** (either domestic or international) and provide reimbursement support.
 - We have **sufficient GPUs** (A100 clusters of Westlake, lab-owned A6000, 4090, etc.). Also, we have collaborations *with* industry, which also offers computing support.
 - **For visiting students:** We prefer **on-site** visits (there are very few positions for online visits for exceptional students). Competitive compensation will be provided to help you rent a room near campus and cover most of your daily expenses (such as on-campus dining).

Qualifications / What Kind of Students We Prefer

1. The prospective students are encouraged to be a “三好学生” (“Merit Students”), which is due to the beloved Dr. [Jian Sun](#), when he once gave a talk at Zhejiang University:

- **Good at math** (“数学好”) - Familiar with the fundamentals of ML (such as linear algebra, calculus, probability theory, statistics, etc.)
 - **Good at coding** (“编程好”) - Strong coding ability with Python, C++ (CUDA programming). Proficient with deep learning platforms like PyTorch / TensorFlow. Familiar with typical deep learning backbones like resnets, transformers.
 - **With a good attitude** (“态度好”) - Good attitude, to me, mostly means
 - **You know why you are here** - Whether it is for dreams, grand research vision, or potential good job opportunities on the market, you *really* think it over and be committed to it.
 - You are **strongly motivated** to explore, hoping to contribute something valuable to the community. As a result, **never give up** when research setbacks happen to you (as they are quite often), and **always stay positive**¹.
 - You act on the **responsibility** to yourself and your colleagues.
2. (Top-tier) Publications are preferred, but not a must.

How to Apply?

Please follow the instructions exactly - very important.

- 1.1 Send an email² to encodelab@westlake.edu.cn, cc wanghuan@westlake.edu.cn, attaching
 - **your CV** (including, if any, your personal webpage, GitHub link, Google Scholar link, etc.),
 - **your transcripts** (with all your past education experiences, e.g., if you are an MS student, please attach both your master's and bachelor's transcripts),
 - and other materials (e.g., award certificates) that can uniquely tell your story.
 - Pay attention to your **email subject**:
 - For Chinese: 应聘<岗位>-<姓名>-<学校>
 - For others: Apply for <position>-<your_name>-<your_university>
 Fyi, the position should be one of the 4 available types: PhD/Visiting/RA/Postdoc.
- 1.2 Please fill in [this table](#) about some important questions.
- 2. After selection, there will be two to three rounds of online interviews:
 - Slides covering your past experiences (education, research background, internships, etc.) are strongly recommended.
 - Two rounds: In most cases, the student will have the first interview. Then, the PI (Huan Wang) has the second interview. Duration: **30-45 mins**.
 - All comments (from PI and students) will be considered when deciding whether to issue the offer.

¹ Okay, being negative for a while is actually [not that bad](#) :-)

² Due to workload, please understand that I may not be able to reply to every email.